

There was no doubt that Wilhelm Keppler was an ardent Nazi who wanted to expand Nazism by military means. Perhaps his yielding ~~in~~ was based partly on his old association with Haeffliger. In 1933 the two of them had searched Germany secretly for ore deposits, which had resulted in the stockpiling of tungsten ores from 1935 on, at Farben's Bitterfeld plant. As a commercial man, Haeffliger denied knowing anything about the order to stockpile, but his name was on the distribution list. Certainly, Wilhelm Keppler did not at first appreciate the military significance of Farben's New Order for Austria. Nor did Hitler, presumably, for Keppler was his Personal Economic Advisor; Hitler was Austrian himself; and he had approved Keppler's order prohibiting German industry from absorbing Austrian firms.

THE PRESIDENT: "Mr. Defendant, the question is simple. The Prosecution has asked you whether you did receive a copy of this document."

MR. HAEFFLIGER: "I assume so. I don't remember it, but - -"
"That is an answer."

MR. SPRECHER: "As to aluminum plants, do you recall decisions to build them in so-called 'protected areas'? And I refer not to 1938 and 1939, but to 1935 and 1936."

"No."

Sprecher introduced a War Ministry memo, announcing these decisions to Haeffliger, because he had gone to Finland for Farben to buy nickel which could replace aluminum.

"During the year 1936, did you learn of the Army's interest in a so-called 'crisis' in the light-metal field - - at the very beginning of the Four Year Plan?"

"I don't know about any crisis at that time."

So it went: Haeffliger's ignorance and the Prosecution documents naming him on the distribution lists. From 1934 on, Farben

(INTERCHANGE)

(INTERCHANGE)

~~---~~ ✓✓